aby

# The Aby user guide

**Sell anyway.**

For shop owners, managers, cashiers and stock keepers. Covers Aby 1.0.1 on Windows, Android and Mac. November 2026.

Aby is the till for your shop. It keeps selling when the light goes off and the network drops. It counts your stock, your cash, your credit book and your MoMo, and it tells you only what you need to act on.

This guide shows you how to do everything in Aby, step by step. You don't need to read it from start to finish. Start with **Part 1** on your first day, then look up what you need when you need it.

> **How to read the steps.** "Settings → Selling → Payment methods" means: open **Settings**, go to the **Selling** tab, then tap **Payment methods**. Buttons and screen names are in **bold**, just as you see them in Aby.

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# 1. Getting started

## 1.1 What you need

- **A till.** A Windows computer (Windows 10 or later), an Android tablet or phone, or a Mac. Aby runs well on a cheap tablet.
- **Nothing else to start.** Aby works without the internet. A receipt printer, cash drawer, barcode scanner and scale are all optional. Add them when you are ready (Part 15).
- **Wi-Fi, only if you have more than one till.** Tills share sales over the shop's own Wi-Fi. They still don't need the internet (Part 16).

## 1.2 Installing Aby

**On Windows:** run **AbySetup** (the file from Abytrone Technologies or your Aby supplier). Accept the licence agreement, choose whether you want a desktop icon, and finish. Aby opens at the end.

- Installing needs a Windows administrator account. After that, anyone can use Aby.
- The installer lets Aby talk to your other tills over Wi-Fi, so Windows won't stop and ask about it.
- **Upgrading** is the same: run the new AbySetup. Your shop's data is never part of the install. Upgrading, or even uninstalling, does not touch your sales, stock or backups.

**On Android:** install the Aby app from the link or file your supplier gives you. When Aby asks for the camera (for scanning) or Bluetooth (for printers and scales), allow it.

**On a Mac:** open the Aby app your supplier gives you. If macOS asks whether Aby may use the network, allow it.

## 1.3 The first start

The first time Aby opens, it asks how you want to begin. There are three ways:

| You are… | Choose |
|---|---|
| Starting Aby in a new shop | **Set up your shop** |
| Moving your shop to a new computer or tablet | **Restore from a backup** (see 18.5) |
| Adding a second till to a shop that already uses Aby | **Join the shop's hub** (see 16.3) |

To **set up your shop**:

1. **What kind of shop?** Choose the closest: ice cream / cold store, provision shop, chop bar / restaurant, pharmacy shop, salon / barber, phones and accessories, boutique, building materials, or something else. Aby uses your choice to start you off with the right categories and switch on features that fit: - a **chop bar** gets takeaway / eat in / delivery and order numbers with kitchen tickets; - a **provision shop** or **pharmacy** asks for expiry dates on new stock; - an **ice cream shop** gets stamp cards and expiry dates; - a **salon** gets 10% staff commission.

You can change all of this later in **Settings → Shop → Features**. 2. **Shop name** and **Your name**. 3. **Your PIN.** You're the owner. Pick a 4-digit PIN. You use it to sign in and to approve things like voids. Don't share it. 4. Tap **Create owner and start**. 5. Aby shows your **recovery code** (like `K7QM-4XPA-9TRB`). Write it down and keep it away from the till. If you ever forget your PIN, it lets you set a new one. Aby shows it only this once.

You are **staff number 101**. While you are the only person, Aby asks just for your PIN. Once you add staff, everyone signs in with their staff number and then their PIN.

**Your shop starts empty.** There are no sample products. Aby already has the payment methods, reasons lists, expense categories and Ghana tax rates (NHIL, GETFund and VAT, switched off until you need them). Want to look around with a full shop first? Use **training mode** (Part 19).

## 1.4 Activating Aby

Aby is a **one-time purchase** for your shop. It never expires. One licence covers the main till (the hub) and as many other tills as you bought it for.

Until Aby is activated, a band at the top says: *"Aby isn't activated on this device. You can look at reports, export and back up, but not sell or change stock, customers or cash."* Nothing is lost. Your data stays safe and readable.

To activate:

1. Open **Settings → Backup → License**.
2. Send the **Device code** shown there (four groups of four letters and numbers, like `K7QM-2XRA-PL3D-9WEH`) to Abytrone Technologies or your Aby supplier, by WhatsApp or email. Say how many tills you will use.
3. You get a **licence key** back, as text or as a `.abylicense` file.
4. Paste the key into **License key**, or tap **Open a license file**, then tap **Activate**.

You'll see *"Aby is activated. Thank you!"*

- **Several tills?** Activate the **hub** only (Part 16). Every till linked to it can then sell. On those tills the License page says *"This device uses the hub's license."*
- **Need more tills later?** Ask for a new key that covers more devices, and enter it under **New license key (for more devices)**.
- **Training mode always works**, even without a licence.

| If Aby says | It means |
|---|---|
| That isn't a complete license key | Part of the key was cut off when copying. Copy all of it and try again. |
| That license is for another device | The key was made for a different device code. Check the code you sent. |
| That license key wasn't made by Aby, or it was changed | The key was mistyped or edited. Paste it again exactly as you got it. |
| That license covers fewer devices than are linked to this hub | Remove tills you no longer use (Part 16.5), or ask for a key for more devices. |

## 1.5 Your first day: a checklist

Do these once, in this order. Each takes a few minutes.

1. **Shop details:** Settings → Shop: name, phone, address. These print on receipts.
2. **Payment methods:** Settings → Selling → Payment methods. Switch on what you take (MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, card…) and add your MoMo merchant number (4.2).
3. **Products:** Manage → Products. Add your products or import a list (Part 9).
4. **Stock (optional):** Manage → Stock, if you want Aby to count stock (Part 10).
5. **Staff:** Manage → Staff. Add each person with their own PIN and role (Part 14).
6. **Printer (optional):** Settings → Receipts and orders → Receipt printer → **Print a test page** (Part 15).

7. **Backup password:** Settings → Backup → **Send a backup off this device**. Set a password you won't forget and send your first backup to WhatsApp or Drive (Part 18).
8. **Practise:** let new cashiers try training mode before their first real sale (Part 19).

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# 2. Finding your way around

## 2.1 Signing in

**Who's on the till?** asks for your **staff number** (three digits, like 104), then your **PIN**. No names are shown, so customers and other staff can't see who works here.

- **Your staff number** is on your page (your name at the top → **My profile**) and in the Staff list. Forgot it? A manager can look it up.
- **Two people may have the same PIN.** The staff number says who you are, so PINs don't need to be different.
- **Badge:** if you have a staff badge, scan it with the barcode scanner (or the camera on Android) instead of typing your number, then type your PIN.
- **Five wrong tries** lock that staff number for 30 seconds. More wrong tries after that lock it for longer each time, up to 15 minutes, even if Aby is closed and opened again. This stops someone guessing. Aby never says whether the number or the PIN was wrong.
- **PIN pad:** Settings → This device → **PIN keypad** can shuffle the numbers every time, so no one learns a PIN by watching where your finger goes. Or it can hide the keypad and use the keyboard.

## 2.2 Sell and Manage

Aby has two sides:

- **Sell:** the **till**, **Today** (today's sales, refunds, cash) and **Orders** (only when you use order numbers).
- **Manage: Dashboard**, **Products**, **Stock**, **Customers**, **Money**, **Reports**, **Staff**, **Activity** and **Settings**.

On a tablet or computer these sit in a bar down the left side. On a phone they are at the bottom.

**Everyone sees only what their role allows.** A cashier usually sees Sell, Today and their own settings. The owner sees everything.

## 2.3 The bar at the top

From left to right:

- **Your shop's name.** When you have more than one branch, a badge shows which one this till is at.
- **The status dot**, which answers *"Is everything safe?"* (18.1). It says what is happening: it pulses with **Backing up…** while a backup is made, then shows **Backed up**. Otherwise green means **All safe**, and amber or red names what needs you, such as **Copy a backup off**. Tap it to see everything, with **Back up now** and a button to fix each problem.
- **Search** (or **Ctrl+K** on a keyboard). One box finds products, customers, sales (by number or MoMo reference), staff and actions. Type "close day", "add an expense" or "receive stock" and press Enter. You only see what you're allowed to do.
- **The printer button:** reprints the last receipt.

**Search boxes on lists** (Products, Stock, Customers, a stock count) remember what you typed. Come back to the screen and the search is still there, with the list it filters; tap **×** in the box to clear it. - **Your name: Switch user**, **Lock**, and **Clock in / Start a break / End the break / Clock out** if your shop uses the time clock.

## 2.4 Locking and switching

- **Lock** when you step away. The cart is kept exactly as it was.

- Aby **locks by itself** when nobody has touched it for 3 minutes. Change this in Settings → This device → **Lock the till after**.
- **Switch user** lets the next person sign in with their staff number and PIN without losing the cart.
- Closing Aby signs everyone out.

## 2.5 When someone else must approve

Some actions need a permission you may not have: a big discount, a void, a refund without a receipt, opening the drawer. Aby asks: *someone allowed to do this enters their staff number and PIN*. A manager or the owner types theirs on your till and the action goes ahead.

Both names, yours and the approver's, go in the activity log. Nobody needs to share their PIN, and nobody has to sign you out.

## 2.6 Messages from Aby

Short messages slide in at the top of the screen (top right on a computer or wide tablet): green when something worked, red when it didn't. They go away by themselves. Rest the pointer on one to keep it, swipe it away, or tap ×.

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# 3. Selling

## 3.1 The till

The till has products on one side and the **cart** on the other (on a phone, the cart opens from the bottom).

Above the products are tabs:

- **Quick:** your best sellers, arranged by you. In the product editor, switch on **On the Quick tab**, then arrange the order from the till.
- **All:** every product.
- **One tab per category.**
- **Recent:** the last 8 products sold on this till.

**Grid or list:** the grid shows photos; the list fits more on a phone. Switch at the top of the products. Your choice is remembered on this till. Settings → This device → **Till tile size** makes tiles smaller or larger.

## 3.2 Adding things to the cart

| To... | Do this |
|---|---|
| Add one | Tap the product |
| Add several | Type the number (for example **3**), then tap the product |
| Choose a size or options | Tap the product: a sheet opens with its sizes and options (toppings, sugar level), the usual ones already ticked. Pick, then **Add** |
| Add one plain, fast | Press and hold a product with options: it goes in as it stands, with no sheet |
| Find by name | Type in the box at the top: results show as you type |
| Scan a barcode | Scan with your scanner: no need to tap the box first. On Android, the camera button scans too |
| Use a short code | Type the code (for example **12**) and press Enter |
| Sell by weight | Tap the product: Aby reads the scale, or you type the weight (4.4) |
| Sell at a price you type | Tap an open-price product and type the price |

If a scanned barcode isn't known, Aby offers **New product with this barcode** to people allowed to add products.

**Stock:** tracked products show how many can be sold; low quantities are marked and out-of-stock items are refused by default. To allow selling past zero, turn on Settings → Selling → **Sell when out of stock**.

## 3.3 Changing a line in the cart

Tap a line in the cart to:

- change the **quantity**, or the **size and options**;
- give a **discount** on that line (3.4);
- **type the price**, for products set to *Price typed at the till*;

- **change the price** of any other product, only if you are allowed to *Change a price at the till*. For everyone else the price just shows and can't be changed. Changes go in the activity log;
- add a **note** ("no sugar", "extra cold");
- **remove** it.

Taking items off the cart is written in the activity log. Ringing up and removing is how money goes missing, so the owner can see it.

## 3.4 Discounts

- **On one line:** tap the line → **Discount**.
- **On the whole sale:** from the cart menu → **Order discount**. It is shared across the lines to the last pesewa, and tax is worked out on what is left.
- **Percent or amount**, with a **reason** from your list ("Regular customer", "Staff", "Damaged item"…).
- **Saved discounts** ("Student 10%", "Staff meal GH₵ 5.00 off") are one tap. Set them up in Settings → Selling → **Saved discounts**.
- **Limits:** each role can give up to a set discount without asking (cashiers 10%, managers 50%, by default). Above that, someone whose limit covers it enters their PIN.

Automatic promotions such as happy hours apply by themselves (8.3). They show on the line, for example *"Happy hour: -GH₵ 3.75"*.

## 3.5 The rest of the cart menu

- **Note** for the whole order.
- **Takeaway, eat in or delivery**, if your shop asks (Settings → Shop → Features).
- **Add a customer**, for credit, the wallet, loyalty and their history (7.1). Search by the last 4 digits of their phone or by name, or add a new one with just a name and phone.
- **Park** (3.6).
- **Open the drawer (no sale)**: needs a reason, and the permission *Open the drawer without a sale*.
- **Clear**: Aby asks first when there are more than 3 lines.

## 3.6 Parking a sale

A customer has forgotten their money, or the next person in the queue is ready? **Park** the sale under a name ("Kofi, blue shirt"). It shows as a tab above the cart. Tap the tab to bring it back, **rename** it, **merge** it into the sale you're on, or **throw it away** (needs *Void sales*).

Close day warns you about parked sales older than 12 hours (you can change this in Settings → Selling).

> **Power cut?** The cart is saved on the till as you ring up. When the power comes back and Aby opens, the cart is still there.

## 3.7 Weighed products and scales

Products sold **by the kg or litre** ask for the amount when you tap them:

- **With a scale connected** (15.4), Aby reads the weight as the box opens. Tap **Read again** if needed. A weight that is still moving is refused, so wait for it to settle.
- **Without a scale**, type the weight (for example `0.75` kg).

- **Scale labels:** if your scale prints barcode labels, scan the label. Aby reads the weight or price from it. Set the first digits your scale prints (often `2` or `21`) in Settings → Selling → **Scale barcodes**.

## 3.8 Order numbers and the Orders board

For food and drink made to order, switch on Settings → Receipts and orders → **Order numbers**.

- Sales with items that need preparing get a number like **A23**, starting again each day. It shows big when the sale is done and prints on the receipt.
- A **kitchen ticket** prints with what to make, on the kitchen printer, or on the receipt printer if you have only one.
- **Sell → Orders** is the board: **New → Preparing → Ready → Collected**. Tap the button on each card to move it along.
- Choose which items need preparing (**Items that need prep**). Pick nothing and every item counts.
- Show the board on a kitchen tablet and the numbers on a TV (15.6).

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# 4. Taking payment

## 4.1 Paying

Tap the lime **Pay** button. The payment sheet opens over the till.

1. Choose how the customer pays: **Cash**, **MTN MoMo**, **Telecel Cash**, **Card**, **Credit**, **Wallet**, **Gift voucher**…
2. **Cash:** type what they gave you, or tap a quick amount: **Exact**, then the next notes up. The change shows as you type.
3. **MoMo, bank, card:** type the **transaction ID** from the customer's message, if your shop asks for it. The customer display (15.6) shows your MoMo number and a QR code.
4. Tap to complete.

**Sale complete** shows the total and, for cash, the **change** in big numbers. From there: **New sale**, **Print receipt**, or **Send receipt**.

## 4.2 Payment methods

Settings → Selling → **Payment methods**:

- Switch on what you take: Cash, MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, AT Money, Card (terminal), Bank transfer, Cheque, Credit (book), Wallet, Gift voucher. Add your own if you need to.
- Rename any method.
- **Needs a transaction ID:** for MoMo and bank transfers. You can ask for only the **last 4 characters**, which is quicker.
- **Show the shop's number** with a QR code at payment (MoMo merchant number).

> **The same transaction ID can only be used once.** If a customer shows an old MoMo message, Aby refuses it: that payment has already been used. Short (last-4) IDs are checked over 48 hours.

## 4.3 Splitting a payment

A customer pays part in cash and part by MoMo? Type the first amount, tap **Take this payment** (the button for paying part), choose the next method, and pay the rest. Only the **last** payment can be more than what is left, and only in cash, because that is what gives change.

## 4.4 Cash rounding

No small coins? Settings → Selling → **Round cash totals** to the nearest 10 or 50 pesewas. Only cash payments are rounded. The rounding is recorded on each sale and counted at close day.

## 4.5 Credit, wallet and gift vouchers

- **Credit (book):** the sale goes on the customer's account. A customer must be attached. If it takes them over their credit limit, Aby either refuses or asks for the PIN of someone allowed to *Sell on credit* (Settings → Selling → **Credit over the limit**).
- **Wallet:** pays from money the customer holds with you (7.4).
- **Keep the change in their wallet:** instead of handing over GH₵ 3.00 in coins, put it in the customer's wallet.
- **Gift voucher:** type or scan the voucher code. Its balance shows and limits the amount. What is left stays on the voucher for next time (8.2).

## 4.6 Receipts

- **Printed** automatically after each sale, if you have a printer and **Print every receipt** is on.
- **Send receipt:** by **WhatsApp** or **SMS** as text, or as a **PDF** you share. Good for shops with no paper.
- **Reprint the last receipt:** the printer button at the top, on every screen. Reprints go in the activity log.
- **Credit sales** can print two copies: one for the customer, and one for the shop with a line to sign.
- Every receipt has a **QR code**. Scan it at the till or in Refund to open that sale.
- Receipts, refunds, gift vouchers and counter statements end with the small Aby mark and **Powered by Aby**.
- Design your receipt in Settings → Receipts and orders → **Receipt design** (15.2).

## 4.7 Exchanges

A customer brings something back and takes something else? Start from the sale in **Today → Refund → Exchange instead** (5.4). The returned items' value pays for the new ones, and only the difference is paid or given back.

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# 5. Today, refunds and voids

## 5.1 Today

**Today** lists every sale of the business day on this till: number, time, what was bought, who sold it, the customer, how it was paid, any discount, and refunds or voids. At the top: **Total sales**, **Number of sales**, **Refunds**.

**Tap a sale** to see it in full:

- every line, with its options and note;
- **price changes** (the menu price, and who changed it);
- **discounts**, with the reason and who approved them, and promotions;
- the totals, tax and rounding, and each payment (cash given, change, MoMo reference);
- **profit**: cost, profit and margin, for people allowed to see costs;
- refunds taken against it, and its **history** from the activity log.

Print, send, refund or void it from there too.

> **When does the day start?** At 05:00 by default, so a sale at 1:30 am counts on the evening before. Change this in Settings → Shop → **Business day starts at** (18.6).

## 5.2 Finding a sale

- Tap the sale in the list, or
- **Find a sale**: type the number from the receipt (142 for #00142), or
- scan the **QR code** on the receipt, or
- search for it in the top bar by number or MoMo reference.

## 5.3 Refunds

On the sale, tap **Refund**:

1. Choose **what comes back**, and how many of each.
2. **Back into stock?** Yes, or no if it's damaged or melted.
3. A **reason** from your list.
4. **How the money goes back:** the way they paid (the default), cash, MoMo, to their **wallet**, or off their **credit** account.
5. Confirm. Needs *Give refunds*, or someone's PIN.

The refund gets its own number (R-0001) and is linked to the sale. The sale itself never changes. Refunded amounts follow what the customer actually paid, after discounts.

**Refund without a receipt:** Today → **Refund without a receipt**. Needs *Refund without a receipt* and is flagged in the activity log.

## 5.4 Exchanges

On the refund screen, tap **Exchange instead**. The returned items go to the till as credit. Add the new items and pay the difference. If the returned items are worth more, choose how to give the rest back.

## 5.5 Voids

A sale rung up by mistake? Tap **Void** on it. Choose a reason. Aby asks: *"Void this sale? Your name goes in the log."*

- A void puts the stock back and undoes everything on the customer's accounts (credit, wallet, stamps and points) and any gift voucher money.
- Needs *Void sales*, or someone's PIN.
- **You can't void** a sale that has refunds, or a sale in a day that is already closed. Use a refund instead.

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# 6. Cash, the drawer and closing the day

Open **Today → Cash** for everything about the drawer.

## 6.1 Starting the day

**Start the day** before the first sale. *"Count the float: the cash in the drawer before the first sale."* Type the amount, or **Count the float** note by note (GH₵ 200 down to 1p) so you know exactly what was there. Aby suggests the float from the last close.

Each till starts its own day, and the day ends when you close it. With Settings → Selling → **Start the day before selling** on (new shops have it on), **Pay** asks for the float first if the day was not started. With it off you can skip this, but close day then asks for the float instead, and the Z report says the day was not started, because a float typed at the end was never counted.

Starting the day is about the **cash**. Clocking in is about **people's hours** (14.5): they are separate. Starting the day never clocks anyone in. Afterwards Aby only **asks** whether you want to clock in too, and the choice is yours.

How strict your shop is about starting the day, clocking in and who is still in at close is set in one place: Settings → Shop → Features → **Attendance mode** (14.5).

## 6.2 The X report

The **X report** shows the day so far without closing anything: sales, payments by method, cash in and out, and the cash that should be in the drawer. Print it or view it.

## 6.3 Putting cash in and taking it out

- **Put cash in:** change from the bank, the owner putting money in.
- **Take cash out:** paying for ice, transport, supplies.

Each needs a **reason**, can have a note and a **photo of the receipt**, and needs *Pay out from the drawer*. The drawer opens if you have one. A cash-out can also be marked as an **expense** in the same step, so it shows in Money (12.1) and is counted once.

## 6.4 The safe and the bank

Needs *Look after the safe and check MoMo*.

- **Move cash to the safe** during the day, so less sits in the drawer.
- **The safe** (Today → Cash → Safe): its balance and history, and **bank deposits** with the bank, slip number and a photo of the slip.

## 6.5 Check MoMo

**Check MoMo** lists every MoMo payment of the day, from sales and customer repayments, with its reference. Go through your MoMo statement and **tick** each one, or **flag** it as missing (flagged ones go in the activity log). Network charges and e-levy have their own line, and Aby shows what should be in your MoMo wallet.

## 6.6 Closing the day (the Z report)

Today → **Close day**. Needs *Close the day*.

The **Close day** button is **off** when nothing has happened since the last close: no started day, no sales, refunds, cash in or out or no-sales. Hold the pointer over it to see why. This stops an empty Z report being written by accident. It turns on as soon as anything happens, and a started day counts even before the first sale.

Before you count, Aby warns you if the day was not started on this till. It also lists **who is still clocked in** on this till, when they clocked in, and what closing will do about them. That depends on Settings → Shop → Features → **At close, people still clocked in** (14.5):

- **Flag for review** (the usual choice): they stay clocked in, and their hours are **not paid** until an owner decides (14.5).
- **Wait for them:** you can't close until each person has clocked out on a till, or their hours have been corrected. The list shows **Correct hours** and **Check again**.
- **Leave open, no review:** they stay clocked in and are paid up to their last sale.
- **Clock out at closing time:** they are clocked out at the close time, recorded as **automatic**.

Whoever closes the day **can never clock someone else out**. The only choices are to correct their hours with a reason (needs *Manage staff*), or to leave them open as above.

1. **Count the drawer**: type the total, or count notes and coins.
2. Aby shows what was expected: float + cash sales + cash from customers + cash put in − cash taken out − cash refunds − safe drops. With **blind count** on (Settings → Selling), the expected amount appears only **after** you count, and your count can't then be changed.
3. If you are **over or short** by more than your limit (GH₵ 5.00 by default), Aby asks why. Aby says "Short by GH₵ 7.00", not "Variance".
4. Close. The **Z report** prints if you have a printer. Past Z reports can be reprinted.

After close day:

- The finished screen names anyone who was left clocked in or clocked out automatically.
- Those sales are **locked** against voids. Refunds still work.
- Aby **makes a backup** on the till.
- The **daily summary** card is ready to send as a picture by WhatsApp: sales, profit before expenses (when costs are known), the cash difference, the top product and what needs attention.

The Z report shows: sales, voids, discounts, refunds, payments by method, rounding, float, cash from customers, pay-ins, pay-outs, safe drops, expected cash, the difference, and no-sales per person. Owners can see over and short per person for the last 30 days.

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# 7. Customers and the credit book

Manage → **Customers**. Needs *Look after customers and their accounts*. Cashiers can still find and add customers at the till.

## 7.1 Adding customers

At the till: cart → **Add a customer**, then search by the **last 4 digits** of their phone or their name, or add a new one with just a **name and phone**. In Customers: tap **Add**.

Phone numbers can be typed any way you like ("024 123 4567", "+233 24…"). Each number belongs to one customer only.

The customer's page shows: what they **owe**, what they **hold** (wallet), how late their debt is, unpaid sales, their account, how much they spend, visits, last visit and what they buy most.

## 7.2 The credit book

- **Credit sales** go on the customer's account (4.5).
- **Credit limit:** set one per customer, or leave it empty for no limit.
- **Days to pay:** debt shows as current, 1–30, 31–60 or over 60 days late.
- **Record a payment:** any method (MoMo needs its reference). It pays the oldest debt first, or a sale you choose. Cash payments count in the drawer at close day.
- **Write off** a debt that won't be paid. Owners only by default (*Write off credit*). It goes in the activity log.
- **Statement:** a PDF for any dates, to share or print.
- **Send a reminder:** opens WhatsApp with your message, for example *"Hello Ama, a friendly reminder from Scoops Tamale: your balance is GH₵ 45.00. Thank you!"* Edit the wording in Settings → Selling → **Credit reminder message**.
- **Customer balance** can print on the receipt printer, for the counter.

## 7.3 Who owes you

The Customers list shows who owes what, and who is late. The dashboard and notifications remind you about late credit.

## 7.4 The wallet

The wallet is money you hold for a customer:

- money they **paid in ahead** (a top-up);
- **change they kept** ("Keep GH₵ 3.00 change in their wallet");
- **refunds** to the wallet.

They spend it with the **Wallet** payment method.

# 8. Loyalty, gift vouchers and promotions

## 8.1 Loyalty

Settings → Shop → Features → **Loyalty**. Choose **one** style for your shop:

| Style | How it works |
|---|---|
| **Stamps** | One stamp per item you choose (for example every cone). After 9 stamps (you choose), the next one is free. |
| **Points** | Points per cedi spent. Every 100 points (you choose) takes GH₵ 5.00 (you choose) off. Points can expire after days without a purchase. |
| **Gold** | Customers who spent a set amount in the last 90 days get a percent off everything. |

Attach the customer at the till and the reward **applies by itself**. The cart shows *"Ama has a free item"*, *"4 of 9 stamps"* or *"230 points: GH₵ 10.00 off"*, and the receipt prints their balance.

Customers are known by their phone number, so ask for it at the till.

## 8.2 Gift vouchers

Customers → **Gift vouchers**:

- **Sell a voucher:** choose its value and how long it lasts (12 months by default). Take the money any way except credit, wallet or another voucher. You get a code like `SCO-7KQ4` with a QR code, printed or sent as a PDF.
- **Spend it** at checkout with the **Gift voucher** payment method. It can be spent in parts until it runs out.
- A voucher sold is **money in, not a sale**. It becomes a sale when it is spent.

## 8.3 Automatic promotions

Settings → Shop → Features → **Promotions** (needs *Change prices*). Five kinds:

| Kind | Example |
|---|---|
| **Percent off** | Happy hour: 20% off all drinks, 4 pm to 6 pm, Monday to Friday |
| **Buy some, get some** | Buy 2 cones, get the cheapest one free |
| **Bundle price** | A cone and a drink together for GH₵ 25.00 |
| **Quantity price** | 6 or more doughnuts at GH₵ 4.00 each |
| **Spend reward** | Spend GH₵ 100.00, get 10% off (or GH₵ 10.00 off, or a free item) |

Each promotion works on chosen products, categories or everything, with start and end dates, days of the week, and a time window (it can pass midnight). If several promotions apply and they don't **stack**, the best deal for the customer wins. Promotions print on the receipt apart from manual discounts.

## 8.4 Combos

A **combo** is a product whose options are other products. For example, "Cone + drink" with a "Pick a cone" and a "Pick a drink" group. When you make an option, switch on **Is a product (combo part)**. The combo sells at its own price, and each part's stock goes down.

# 9. Products and prices

Manage → **Products**. Tabs: **Products**, **Categories**, **Options**, **Tax**. Adding and editing needs *Add and edit products*. Changing prices needs *Change prices*.

## 9.1 A product

Tap **Add** (or a product to edit it):

- **Name** and **category**.
- Product names are unique (ignoring case and surrounding spaces). A stock item linked to a product may use the same name; names are unique within each list. If an older database has duplicate names, Aby keeps both records and adds a numbered suffix to the later name.
- **Sizes and prices:** every product has at least one price. Add sizes ("Single scoop GH₵ 15.00", "Double scoop GH₵ 22.00") for more.
- **Sold by:** each, by the kg, or by the litre.
- **Open price:** the cashier types the price, between limits you can set.
- **Options:** add option groups such as Extras or Sugar level (9.3).
- **Barcodes:** scan them in, or type them. A short code (like `12`) works as a barcode too.
- **Photo:** take one or pick one. Without a photo, the tile shows the category's picture.
- **Inventory tracking:** leave it off for products you do not count, choose **One stock item** for ordinary retail products, or choose **Recipe** for products made from multiple stock items. Stock links are saved by record ID, not inferred from matching names. If you add the stock item later, edit the product and select it; matching names alone will not link them. Aby uses the linked stock cost or recipe to work out profit.
- **Tax** (9.4).
- **On the Quick tab** and **On the till** (switch off to hide it from the till without deleting it).
- **Commission per product**, if your shop pays it that way (14.6).

**Archive** a product you no longer sell. Its history stays. **Duplicate** makes a copy to edit, named "… (copy)" and kept off the till until you check it.

## 9.2 Categories

Each category has a name, a colour and a picture. Products without a photo show their category's picture on the till.

## 9.3 Options

Options are choices or add-ons on a product, such as **Extras**, **Milk**, **Sugar level** or **Sauce**. Name each group for your shop: the name is the heading the cashier sees on the till. For each group set:

- the **least** and **most** a customer can pick ("pick 1", "up to 3");
- whether the same one can be picked **twice** ("double sprinkles");
- each option's extra price.

## 9.4 Tax

Products → **Tax** → **How tax works here** decides how tax works:

- **No tax**: you're not registered. Most small shops start here.

- **Prices include tax**: the usual way in Ghana. The price on the tile is what the customer pays.
- **Add tax at the till**: added on top at checkout.

Only turn tax on if your shop is registered.

The tax rates (NHIL, GETFund, VAT) are on the same tab. Set which rates apply to which products. The receipt shows the tax included, and Reports shows tax per rate.

## 9.5 Changing prices

- **One product:** edit its price.
- **Later:** schedule a new price for a coming day. It starts when that business day starts.
- **Many at once: Tools → Change prices** for a category or everything, by a percent or an amount.
- **Margins:** products below your target margin (50% by default) are flagged. The target is in Settings.

All price changes go in the activity log.

## 9.6 Importing and exporting your product list

**Tools → Export** saves your products as CSV, which opens in Excel or Google Sheets. **Tools → Import** brings a CSV back:

- You see a **preview** first.
- It **adds** new products and **updates** prices, costs, barcodes, stock counts and what shows on the till.
- It **never removes** anything.
- If any row has a problem, **nothing** is imported. Fix the row and try again.
- `on_hand` tracks each product or size in pieces; each sale deducts one. `low_below` marks the quantity at which that SKU is shown as low. New SKUs with both fields blank remain untracked; blank fields on an existing SKU leave its stock settings unchanged. On an update, `on_hand` is the new counted total and is recorded as a stock adjustment.
- The exported CSV also includes `stock_item`, `stock_quantity` and `sell_by`. `stock_item` is the exact name of an existing item from Stock; import the stock list first if needed. `stock_quantity` is the positive whole number of base units consumed per sale (pieces, grams or millilitres), and `sell_by` is `each`, `kg` or `litre`. These columns preserve direct stock links, including weighed products, when moving the product list. If `cost` is supplied for a linked product, it updates the linked stock item's cost to match the cost per sale. An empty `cost` leaves that cost unchanged. `on_hand` and `low_below` remain piece counts; use **Import stock** for bulk counts of weighed stock items.
- For a regular retail item, choose **One stock item** under Inventory tracking in the product form, then select the stock item and amount used per sale. This explicit link controls the stock deduction and uses the stock item's current cost.
- For products made from several ingredients, choose **Recipe** instead. Recipes continue to deduct their ingredients and options when sold.
- When `on_hand` is supplied for a simple SKU, import can match or create its piece-based stock item by product name (or `product - variant`) and save that as an explicit link. Sales no longer match products to stock items by name.

## 9.7 Products from stock

When you sell things as you buy them (bottled water, biscuits, a bag of sugar), let Aby make the products: Products → Tools → **Products from stock** (also on Stock → Tools).

- Tick the stock items to sell. Items already sold as a product, or with a product of the same name, start unticked.

- Choose **Margin** (the share of the price that is profit: cost 6.00 at 40% sells at 10.00) or **Markup** (added to the cost: cost 6.00 at 40% sells at 8.40). It starts at your target margin.
- Choose how prices round (to 10p, 50p or GH₵ 1), always up so the profit is never less.
- Tap any price to type your own. Each row shows the profit per sale.
- Each item gets its **own category** from its name where Aby can tell ("Vanilla ice cream" goes in Ice cream, "Cones" in the category of your Cone product). Tap the category under any item to change it. **Category for the rest** (an existing one, or a new one) is for items Aby could not place.
- **Make products**.

Each product is explicitly linked to its stock item, so a sale deducts the correct amount and uses that item's cost. Items kept in grams or millilitres become products sold by the kg or litre.

Stock item names are unique too. Importing an existing name updates that stock record; making a product from stock keeps the relationship tied to its record ID. Products and their linked stock item can share a name.

## 9.8 Labels and barcodes

Products → Tools → **Labels**:

- Choose how many labels of each product.
- **Make barcodes** gives products without a barcode their own ( `ABY00001` and up).
- Print on **A4 sheets of 24**, a **50 × 30 mm roll** (for label printers), or as **stickers** on the receipt printer.

After a delivery, Aby offers to print labels for what came in.

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# 10. Stock

Manage → **Stock**. Tabs: **Items**, **Deliveries**, **Counts**, **Suppliers**, **Orders**, plus **Expiring** and **Transfers** when you use them.

## 10.1 Stock items

A **stock item** is what you count: a tub of vanilla, a crate of Coke, a bag of rice. It is counted in **pieces**, **grams** or **millilitres** (shown as kg and L when large).

Each item shows what is **on hand**, what it cost on average, its history, how much is used a day, **how long it will last**, and a **suggested low level**.

> Product imports can start tracking individual SKUs with `on_hand` and `low_below`. Direct stock links are included in product CSV exports. For products made from multiple ingredients, use recipes instead. Products with neither remain untracked and simply sell.

**Import stock** (Stock → Tools → **Import stock**) works like the product import: download the sample (or export your stock to start from it), fill it in Excel or Google Sheets, and pick the CSV. Columns: `stock_item` (needed), `unit` (piece, g or ml), `cost_per` (pcs, kg, g, L or ml), `cost`, `on_hand`, `low_below`, `order_qty` (the usual order) and `supplier` (a new name becomes a new supplier). Importing the name of a retired item brings it back. You see a preview first. A count that changes is recorded as an adjustment, so the item's history shows the import. It never removes anything.

## 10.2 How stock moves

Aby never just "sets" stock. Every change is written down: **sold**, **received**, **wasted**, **corrected**, **counted**, **returned**, **made here**, **sent** or **received from a branch**. What is on hand is the sum of all of them, so you can always see why a number is what it is.

## 10.3 Recipes

A product's **recipe** says what stock it uses. A "Single scoop vanilla cone" might use 80 ml of vanilla ice cream and 1 cone. Each sale takes exactly that off stock, and the product's cost comes from it. Sizes and toppings can have their own recipes.

## 10.4 Waste and corrections

On a stock item:

- **Waste:** melted, power cut, expired, dropped or damaged, staff, free sample, other. It is recorded with its value.
- **Correct stock:** you found more, or less, than Aby thinks. Add a note.

Both need *Adjust stock* and go in the activity log.

## 10.5 Stock counts (stocktake)

Stock → Counts → **New count**:

1. Choose **blind** (counters don't see what Aby expects) or **open**.
2. Count and type each item. You can keep selling while you count, because Aby remembers what it expected at the moment you counted each item.

3. **Post** the count (needs *Approve stock counts*). Differences become corrections. Items you didn't count don't change.

## 10.6 Low stock

Each item has a **low level**. Below it, the item shows as low, the dashboard alerts you, and Aby can send a notification. Aby suggests a level from how fast the item sells.

## 10.7 Batches and expiry dates

Switch on **Track batches and expiry** on an item (milk, yoghurt, medicine). Deliveries then ask for the batch and expiry date. Aby assumes you sell the **first to expire, first** and works out what is left of each batch.

**Stock → Expiring** lists what expires in the next 30 days. An alert warns you a week ahead.

## 10.8 Making things in the shop

Do you make your own milkshake base, batter or juice? On that stock item: **Made here? Set its recipe.** Say what one batch makes and what goes in it. Then **Record a batch made**: the ingredients come off stock and the made item goes up, at what the ingredients cost.

---

# 11. Suppliers, orders and deliveries

## 11.1 Suppliers

Stock → **Suppliers**: each supplier with their phone and what you **owe** them. On a supplier's page: their account, past deliveries, and **Pay** (needs *Pay out from the drawer*).

## 11.2 Purchase orders

Stock → **Orders** → **New order**:

1. Pick the supplier. Aby brings in their items that are **low**, at the usual order quantity (set on each item, or in the stock import's `order_qty` column).
2. Change each **Quantity** (in the item's unit: L, kg or pcs), add more, set a **needed by** date and a note.
3. **Save or print**: the order as a PDF (item, quantity, unit, expected price) to share by WhatsApp or email, save to a folder, or, on a computer, open to print.

Not in your stock list yet? Choose **+ New stock items…** at the top of a line's item list. Type one item or several: name, unit (pcs, kg or L), quantity and cost per unit. They are saved to your stock list, linked to the supplier, and put on the order (the first on that line, the rest below it).

When goods arrive, tap **Create delivery** on the order (each waiting order has the button in the list too). It can arrive in parts: the order goes from **Waiting** to **Part delivered** to **Delivered**. The order's page lists the deliveries made from it; tap one to open it. You can cancel an order.

## 11.3 Receiving a delivery

Stock → **Deliveries** → **Receive delivery**. Needs *Receive stock*. When orders are waiting, Aby asks first which order the delivery is for, or **without an order**.

From an order, the form is already filled with what is still to come, at the cost expected. Each line shows what was ordered and what came before. Change a **Quantity** if less came, and put **0** for what did not come: the order keeps waiting for it.

- What came in: the **Quantity** (in the item's unit) and the **Cost of this line** from the invoice. Something new? **+ New stock items…** at the top of the line's item list makes one or several, with their quantities and costs. They join your stock list and the delivery together.
- Batch and expiry date, for items that track them.
- The supplier, and whether you **paid now** or **owe** it. Without a supplier, it must be paid in full.

Aby updates the average cost. If Aby thought the item had run out, the new cost replaces the old one.

After saving, Aby shows what the delivery changed:

- each item's stock before and after, and its cost when the price changed;
- whether the order is fully delivered or still waiting for some items;
- products whose margin is now **below your target** because costs went up, with **Review prices** to go straight to them;
- **Print labels** for products sold as they came in.

Stock → **Deliveries** lists every delivery with what is still owed. Tap one to see it: each item with its quantity, unit and cost, the total, paid and owed. **Save or print** makes its goods note (a PDF with a line to sign) to share, save, or open to

print. Tap an item's name to open the stock item.

**Update stock items** (on a delivery, or on the summary right after saving one) brings each stock item in line with the delivery. The stock it brought in is already counted; for each item you tick what else follows the delivery:

- **Cost**: this delivery's price, instead of the average of everything bought;
- **Supplier**: who delivered it, so the next order to them suggests it;
- **Usual order**: the quantity that came, as the amount to order next time.

Only what differs is shown, all ticked to begin with. A delivery updates its stock items once: after that its button reads **Stock items updated** (with when), or **Stock items match** when there is nothing to change.

Deliveries are numbered **DEL-0001**, **DEL-0002** and so on. On a stock item's page, each delivery in its history shows its number and supplier ("Received · DEL-0004 from Sally Ent."); tap it to open the delivery.

---

# 12. Money: expenses and profit

Manage → **Money**. Expenses need *Record expenses and the owner's money*. Profit needs *See costs and profit*.

## 12.1 Expenses

**Add an expense:** date, amount, category (Rent, Electricity (ECG), Water, Generator fuel, Transport, Ice, Staff wages, Repairs, Phone credit and data, Packaging, Other, or your own), paid from **the drawer**, **MoMo**, **the bank** or **the owner's pocket**, the supplier, a note and a photo of the receipt.

Paid from the drawer, it also counts as cash taken out, so close day is right.

**Monthly reminders:** "Rent GH₵ 800.00 on the 1st". When it is due, record it or skip it.

## 12.2 Profit

**Profit** for today, this week, this month, last month or any dates, beside the same length of time before:

```
  Sales at menu prices
- discounts - refunds - tax
= Net sales
- what the stock cost
= Gross profit (and margin)
- expenses by category
- stock thrown away ± count differences
= Net profit
```

Tax collected is taken off because it is owed to GRA. Deliveries are not expenses: stock counts as a cost when it is sold.

> **For the right profit,** give products a cost or a recipe. Products with no cost count as costing nothing.

## 12.3 Owner's money

The owner **taking money out** for themselves (drawings), or **putting their own money in**, kept apart from expenses. You see what the owner took home.

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# 13. Dashboard and reports

## 13.1 Dashboard

Manage → **Dashboard** (needs *See reports*) shows **today, live**:

- sales today against the same day last week;
- number of sales and the average sale;
- takings by payment method;
- an hour-by-hour strip, and the top 5 products;
- **the drawer**: who started the day, and the cash that should be there;
- **alerts**: low stock, late credit, backups due, a day not closed, old parked sales, expenses due, stock expiring.

At the top, **Worth knowing** points out things such as stock that runs out in under 3 days at this week's pace, your busiest day, a product's margin falling, customers more than 30 days late, and cash short 3 or more times this month. Each one has a button that takes you where you can deal with it, **Not now** (hidden for a week) and **Don't show these**.

Reorder or hide cards to suit you. Your layout is kept for you.

## 13.2 Reports

Manage → **Reports** for today, this week, this month, last month or any dates, always beside the period before:

| Report | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Sales** | the breakdown, and a day-by-day chart |
| **Times** | by hour, and a day × hour map of your busy times |
| **Products** | best sellers, A/B/C grades, categories, options, products not selling |
| **Payments** | by method, and rounding |
| **Staff** | sales, items, average sale, hours, discounts, voids, refunds, no-sales, short counts, commission |
| **Customers** | new and returning, top customers, who owes, who is late, wallets |
| **Stock and tax** | stock value, movements at cost, waste, count differences, tax per rate |

Costs and profit only show for people with *See costs and profit*. With several branches, choose **All branches** or one.

## 13.3 Exporting

Every list and report can be exported as **Excel**, **PDF** or **CSV**, then shared or saved. Needs *Export data and backups*. The PDFs and workbooks carry your shop's name and logo in Aby's design.

Wherever Aby makes a PDF (a purchase order, a delivery, a statement, a report) it asks where it goes: **Share** (WhatsApp, email…), **Save to a folder**, or, on a computer, **Open to print**, which opens it in your PDF viewer to print (Ctrl+P).

## 13.4 The accountant's pack

Reports → **For the accountant**: one zip for the month with sales, payments, refunds, expenses, purchases, tax and the stock value, as CSV files and one Excel workbook, plus a PDF summary.

**Every month, by itself:** Settings → Backup → **Save the accountant's pack every month**. Turn it on at the computer your accountant reads from, and choose the folder (a USB stick or shared folder is fine). From the 1st, last month's pack is saved there. If the computer was off, Aby catches up. If the folder isn't there (the USB stick is out), the status dot turns amber with **Try again**.

On Android, packs stay in the app. Use **Share the latest pack**.

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# 14. Staff, roles and the activity log

Manage → **Staff**. Needs *Manage staff*.

## 14.1 Adding staff

**Add** a person: name, **role**, and a 4-digit **PIN** they choose. You can also add their phone, photo, Ghana Card number, usual hours and notes. Aby gives each person a **staff number** (101, 102 and so on) and shows it when you add them. They type it before their PIN. Two people can choose the same PIN. Never share PINs: the activity log trusts them.

You can **change a PIN**, **change the role**, or **deactivate** someone who has left. Their sales and history stay.

## 14.2 Roles

Four roles come with Aby. Owners can add their own (Staff → **Roles**, needs *Manage roles*).

| Role | Can do (by default) | Discount without asking |
|---|---|---|
| **Owner** | everything, always | 100% |
| **Manager** | everything except manage roles, restore a backup, write off credit | 50% |
| **Cashier** | sell, close the day | 10% |
| **Stock keeper** | receive stock, adjust stock, add and edit products | none |

## 14.3 Permissions

Each role is a list of these:

| Area | Permissions |
|---|---|
| Sell | Sell · Change a price at the till · Give refunds · Refund without a receipt · Void sales · Open the drawer without a sale |
| Products and stock | Add and edit products · Change prices · Receive stock · Adjust stock · Approve stock counts |
| Customers | Look after customers and their accounts · Sell on credit · Write off credit |
| Cash | Close the day · Pay out from the drawer · Look after the safe and check MoMo · Record expenses and the owner's money |
| Reports | See reports · See costs and profit |
| Admin | Manage staff · Manage roles · Change settings · Manage devices and the hub · See the activity log · Export data and backups · Restore a backup |

When someone lacks a permission, anyone who has it can approve with their staff number and PIN (2.5).

## 14.4 Staff at one branch

With several branches, you can limit a person to **one branch**. They can then sign in only there. Owners sign in everywhere.

## 14.5 Badges and the time clock

- **Make a badge** on a person's page: a card with a QR code, printed on the receipt printer or shared as a PDF. Scanning it at sign-in stands in for their staff number. They still type their PIN. **New badge** stops the old one working.
- **Clock in and out** from your name at the top: **Clock in**, **Start a break**, **End the break**, **Clock out**.
- Settings → Shop → Features → **Clock in before selling** (on for new shops) asks people to clock in when they sign in, and again at **Pay** if they said not now. Someone on a break is asked to end it before they take payment. **Signing in never clocks anyone in**: each person clocks themselves in, and only they can clock themselves out.
- Staff → **Timesheets** for any week or dates: hours worked, breaks, late arrivals and early leaves (with 5 minutes' grace). Late is judged on a person's first stretch of the day and early on the last, so going out for lunch is neither. Usual hours can cross midnight (22:00 to 06:00). Export to CSV for wages.
- **Forgot to clock out?** A stretch over 16 hours is marked in red. Someone who may manage staff taps the stretch, sets the right times and break, and gives a reason. The change shows on the timesheet and in the Activity log.

**Attendance mode.** Settings → Shop → Features → **Attendance mode** sets several settings at once for the kind of shop you run. You can still change each one on its own afterwards, and the tile then reads **Custom**.

| Mode | Start the day to sell | Clock in to sell | At close, people still clocked in |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Solo or family** | off | off | left open, paid up to their last sale |
| **Standard** (new shops) | on | on | flagged for review, not paid until decided |
| **Strict** | on | on | close day waits until everyone has clocked out or been corrected |

**Hours left open at close.** When someone is still clocked in at close (in Standard mode), Aby keeps what it knows and invents nothing:

- Their stretch shows **not confirmed**, with no clock-out time. Their last sale or refund on that till is kept as a guide, never as their clock-out.
- It is **not paid** until an owner decides. It shows as **Not paid yet**, and is left out of their total and the exported timesheet.
- They can clock in again the next day as normal.

**Deciding (the review queue).** Staff → **Timesheets** shows **Waiting for your decision** at the top, whatever dates are showing. Tap one (needs *Manage staff*): **Pay up to the last activity**, **Pay a set time**, **Do not pay**, or **Set when they really left**. A **reason** is always needed. The decision, who made it and the reason show on the timesheet and in the Activity log. Hours corrected by a manager, and hours clocked out automatically, are labelled the same way, so a person's own clock-out can always be told from someone else's.

## 14.6 Commission

Settings → Shop → Features → **Commission**: off, **a percent of their sales**, or **an amount per product** (set on each product). See it per person in Reports → Staff, for any dates. Refunds don't take commission back. You see refunds per person beside it.

## 14.7 The activity log

Manage → **Activity** (needs *See the activity log*): every sensitive action, **who did it** and **who approved it**, when, and what changed. That includes sign-ins and wrong PINs, voids, refunds, discounts, price changes, items taken off a cart,

no-sales, cash in and out, stock changes, staff and settings changes, backups and exports.

Filter by person, kind of action or dates. Tap an entry to see the details, before and after.

> **Nobody can quietly change the log.** Each entry is sealed to the one before it. If someone edits Aby's data file outside Aby, the activity log and the status dot show a warning.

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# 15. Printers, scales, scanners and screens

Hardware is set up **per till**, in Settings → **Receipts and orders** and Settings → **This device**.

## 15.1 Receipt printer

Settings → Receipts and orders → **Receipt printer**. Aby works with 58 mm and 80 mm thermal receipt printers (the ESC/POS kind most shops use):

| Printer | Choose |
|---|---|
| On the network (Wi-Fi or cable) | **Network**, and type its address |
| USB, on Windows | **Installed printer**, and pick it from the list (install its Windows driver first) |
| Bluetooth, on Android | Pair it in Android's Bluetooth settings first, then pick it |

Choose the **paper width**, then **Print a test page**.

- **Print every receipt**: off means print only when you tap Print.
- If the printer is off or out of paper, receipts **wait and retry by themselves**. The sale is never held up. The status dot shows what is waiting, with **Try again** and **Clear**.
- Receipts print in plain letters because cheap printers have no cedi sign. "GH₵" prints as "GHS".
- **No receipt printer?** Printing offers a PDF instead.

## 15.2 Receipt design

Settings → Receipts and orders → **Receipt design**: your **logo**, a **header** (address, hours), your **MoMo number**, a **footer** ("Thank you. Come again!"), whether to show **who served**, the **customer**, the **tax**, the **QR code**, and **two copies for credit sales**. The preview shows the receipt exactly as it will print.

## 15.3 Cash drawer

A cash drawer plugs into the receipt printer. Switch on **Cash drawer**. It opens for cash sales, cash refunds, cash in or out, safe drops and no-sales. **Open the drawer to test it.**

## 15.4 Scale

Settings → This device → **Scale**:

- **Windows:** a scale on a COM port (serial or USB). Choose the port and speed.
- **Android:** a paired Bluetooth scale.
- Choose how Aby asks for the weight (most scales: nothing, W, P or ENQ) and tap **Read the scale** to check.

## 15.5 Barcode scanners and the camera

- **USB and Bluetooth scanners** work straight away. They type into Aby like a keyboard.
- **Camera (Android):** Settings → This device → **Scan with the camera** shows a camera button next to search, receipts and barcodes.

## 15.6 Screens on other devices

Settings → Receipts and orders → **Screens on other devices**. The till shows three screens in the browser of any tablet, TV or second monitor on the **same Wi-Fi**, with no internet:

- **Customer display:** your logo and today's promotions while idle, the items and total as you ring up, your MoMo number with a QR code at payment, then "Thank you" with the change and order number.
- **Prep screen:** orders to make, with buttons to move them along.
- **Now serving:** order numbers being prepared and ready.

Scan the QR code next to each link with the tablet or TV. **New links** stops the old links working.

## 15.7 Kitchen printer

Settings → Receipts and orders → **Kitchen printer**: where kitchen tickets print. Leave it empty to use the receipt printer.

## 15.8 Notifications

Settings → This device → **Notifications**: alerts as phone or Windows notifications, with no internet. These cover low stock, late credit, backups due, a day not closed, old parked sales, expenses due and stock expiring. Each kind comes at most once a day unless it grows. Each person chooses their own in **Which notifications**.

---

# 16. Several tills: the hub

## 16.1 How it works

One till is the **hub**, usually the main till that is always on. The other tills **link** to it over the shop's Wi-Fi. They share **sales, stock, products, customers, staff and settings**, **with no internet**.

- Each till **keeps selling** if the Wi-Fi drops. It catches up when the Wi-Fi is back.
- If two tills change the same thing, the **later change wins**. Sales and stock are never lost this way, because they are only ever added.
- Everything between tills is **encrypted**, and only paired tills can join.
- **Activate Aby on the hub** (1.4). The linked tills use the hub's licence.

Managing tills and the hub needs *Manage devices and the hub*.

## 16.2 Making the hub

On the main till: Settings → This device → **Devices and hub** → **Make this the hub**. Its products, stock and customers become the shop's data, and the other tills merge into it.

## 16.3 Adding a till

1. On the **hub**: Settings → This device → Devices and hub → **Add a device**. It shows a QR code and an 8-letter code, good for 10 minutes.
2. On the **new till**: - **Brand-new install:** on the first screen, tap **Join the shop's hub**. - **Already set up:** Settings → This device → Devices and hub → **Join a hub**.
3. Scan the QR code (Android), or pick the hub from the list, or type the **Hub address** (like `192.168.1.20:8787`) and the code.

When a till that was already selling joins, **everything on it is merged** into the hub, and the hub's data comes to it. It takes the shop's settings from the hub. Products or customers that appear twice after merging are listed so you can tidy them up.

A brand-new till joining from its first screen simply receives the shop's data, then opens at **Who's on the till?**. If the sync is cut short, tap **Sync with the hub again**.

## 16.4 Is it syncing?

The status dot shows sync. *"3 sales saved on this device. Will sync when online."* is normal when the Wi-Fi is down. If a till says **Cannot reach the hub**, check that the hub is on and on the same Wi-Fi. If the hub's address changes, the tills find it again by themselves.

## 16.5 Managing tills

On the hub, **Devices and hub** lists each paired till with its last contact and Aby version. **Rename** it, set its **role** (till, kitchen, display, owner's device), or **Remove** a lost or stolen one. It can then no longer sync. What it already sent is kept.

**Leave the hub** on a till to stop syncing. It keeps its data and works alone.

# 17. Branches

For a shop with more than one location. Settings → Shop → **Branches**.

- Every shop has a **main branch**. **Add** more with an address and phone, rename them, or close and reopen them.
- **Place each till in its branch** (on that till). Its sales and stock count for that branch. Tills never placed are in the main branch.
- **Stock is counted per branch.** Reports and the dashboard show **All branches** or one.
- **Staff** can be limited to one branch (14.4).
- Moving a till to another branch moves its past sales and stock with it. Aby warns you first.

## 17.1 Sending stock to another branch

Stock → **Transfers → Send**: choose the branch and what to send. The stock leaves this branch at once and shows as **on its way**. The other branch **receives** it, counting what arrived, and any difference is flagged. A transfer not yet received can be **called back**.

## 17.2 Branches with no network between them

Each branch has its own hub. To bring one branch's data to another:

1. At branch A: Settings → Backup → **Send this branch's data** (the encrypted backup file). Send it by WhatsApp, email or USB.
2. At branch B: Settings → Backup → **Bring in a branch data file**, and type the backup password.

The data is **merged, nothing replaced**. Aby makes a safety backup first. Bringing in the same file twice changes nothing.

> Prices are the same at every branch for now, and receipts show the shop's name and address.

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# 18. Keeping your data safe

Your shop's data lives on your till, so keeping it safe matters. Aby does most of it for you.

## 18.1 The status dot: "Is everything safe?"

The dot at the top follows what is happening:

| The dot says | Means |
|---|---|
| **Backing up…** (pulsing) | a backup is being made right now |
| **Backed up** | one just finished (for a few seconds) |
| **All safe** | nothing needs you |
| What needs you, such as **Copy a backup off** or **Backup due** | the most urgent problem; **+1**, **+2** when there are more |

Tap it to see the details. At the top is **Backup on this device**: when the last backup was made, when the next automatic one runs, a **Back up now** button that is always there, and **Open folder** on a computer. Below it, each check:

| Check | Green when |
|---|---|
| **Backup off this device** | one was sent away in the last 7 days |
| **Activity log** | *"Checked. Nothing has been changed."* |
| **Sync** | the hub is reachable, or nothing is waiting |
| **Receipt printer** | *"Ready. Nothing waiting."* |
| **PIN recovery code** | the signed-in owner has one |
| **Accountant pack** | the last monthly pack was saved |

Amber or red comes with a button to fix it.

## 18.2 Automatic backups

- Aby **backs up by itself** while it is open, and **after every close day**, on the till.
- Choose how often in Settings → Backup → **Back up every**: every **1, 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50 or 55 minutes**, **1 hour**, or **once a day**. New shops back up every 30 minutes. Turn **Automatic backups** off to stop them.
- When nothing has changed since the last backup, Aby skips it: the last one is still up to date.
- It keeps the newest **14**, and the last one of each day before them for 14 days, so backing up every minute still leaves last week's (Settings → Backup → **Backups to keep on this device**).
- **Back up now** makes one straight away, in Settings or from the status dot.

**Where are they?** Settings → Backup → **Backup folder** shows the full path. **Copy path** copies it; on a computer, **Open folder** shows it in File Explorer (Windows) or Finder (Mac). Copy the files from there to a USB stick if you like, but **Send a backup off this device** (18.3) is the safer way: it is locked with your password.

## 18.3 Backups off the till

A backup on the till doesn't help if the till is stolen or breaks. Every week:

1. Settings → Backup → **Send a backup off this device**.
2. The first time, set a **backup password** (at least 6 characters). **Write it down somewhere safe.** Without it, no one can open the backup: not you, not Aby.
3. Send the file (`.abybak`) to **WhatsApp** (to yourself), **Google Drive**, **email**, or save it to a **USB stick**.

The file is encrypted with your password. Aby reminds you after 7 days without one.

## 18.4 Restoring

Settings → Backup → **Restore from a file** (or pick one of the **Backups on this device**). Needs *Restore a backup*, which owners have by default.

1. Choose the backup. The file window opens in the **backup folder**, so the till's own backups are right there; go to a USB stick, Downloads or anywhere else from there. Type its password if it is an `.abybak` file.
2. Aby shows what is in it (shop name, number of sales, date) so you can check it's the right one.
3. Confirm. Aby **keeps a safety copy of your data as it is now**, puts the backup in place, and restarts.

On a till linked to a hub, Aby warns you first. After restoring, the till sends its data to the hub again, and newer changes made on the other tills come back.

## 18.5 Moving to a new till

1. On the old till: **Send a backup off this device**.
2. On the new till: install Aby, and on the first screen choose **Restore from a backup**.
3. Aby asks whether the new till **replaces** the old one. Say yes if the old one won't be used again.
4. **Licence:** a licence is tied to its device. Send the new till's device code to get a key for it.

## 18.6 When does the business day end?

Most of Aby works by **business day**: Today, close day, the dashboard, reports, alerts and the daily order numbers (A1, A2…). A business day does not have to end at midnight.

A chop bar open from 4 pm to 2 am serves one night, but midnight would cut it in two: half of tonight's sales on today, half on tomorrow, the drawer count not matching, and order numbers back to A1 in the middle of service. So Aby starts the day at **05:00** by default: everything from 05:00 to 04:59 the next morning is one day, named after the day it started.

Settings → Shop → **Business day starts at**. Pick **a time when you are closed**:

| Your shop | Pick |
|---|---|
| Closes before midnight (pharmacy, boutique) | anything; **Midnight** is simplest |
| Open past midnight (bar, chop bar) | an hour after you close, such as 05:00 or 06:00 |
| Starts work early but opens late (bakery) | before you start, such as 04:00 |
| Works through the night, opens mid-morning | up to **10:00** |

The setting shows what it means, for example *"Runs 06:00 to 05:59 the next morning."*

# 19. Training mode

Practise without touching your real sales. Settings → Backup → **Training mode** (needs *Change settings*).

**Practise with:**

- **A sample shop:** made-up products, stock, suppliers, customers, staff and a month of sales, for your kind of shop. The sample staff's PINs are in their profile notes.
- **A copy of this shop:** your own products and sales as they are now.

Aby restarts on the practice copy. A yellow band says **TRAINING: NOT REAL SALES** on every screen, and receipts say "TRAINING - NOT A REAL SALE".

- Nothing reaches the real sales, stock, reports, backups or other tills.
- Backups, restores and the hub are off while training.
- Training works even before Aby is activated, so it's the best way to look around.
- **Reset training data** starts the practice again, fresh.
- **Leave training** restarts on your real shop, exactly as you left it.

# 20. Settings, one by one

Settings has five tabs. People without *Change settings* see only their own settings for this till.

## Shop

| Setting | What it does |
|---|---|
| Shop name, Phone, Address or landmark | Shown on receipts, PDFs and the customer display |
| Branches | Shop locations (Part 17) |
| What kind of shop? | Chosen at setup; switches features on or off |
| Expiry dates for new stock | New stock items ask for batches and expiry dates |
| Takeaway, eat in or delivery | Asked on each sale; shown on the order ticket |
| Attendance mode | Solo or family, Standard or Strict: sets the three settings below and the start-the-day setting together. Reads Custom when changed one by one |
| At close, people still clocked in | Flag for review, Wait for them, Leave open without review, or Clock out at closing time (14.5) |
| Let staff edit a missed clock-out | Staff may enter when they really finished after the day has changed; the reason is logged |
| Clock in before selling | Staff must clock in to take payment (on for new shops) |
| Commission | Off, a percent of sales, or per product |
| Loyalty | Stamps, points or Gold |
| Promotions | Automatic deals |
| Business day starts at | Midnight, or any hour up to 10:00 (05:00 by default). Sales before it count on the previous day (18.6) |

## Selling

| Setting | What it does |
|---|---|
| Payment methods | What you take, names, transaction IDs, MoMo number |
| Round cash totals | To 10 or 50 pesewas |
| Credit over the limit | Ask for a PIN, or not allowed |
| Credit reminder message | Uses {name}, {amount} and {shop} |
| Sell when out of stock | On: warn but sell. Off: refuse |
| Saved discounts | One-tap named discounts |
| Reasons | Lists for discounts, voids, refunds, no-sales, cash in and out |
| Scale barcodes, The scale barcode holds | Prefix, and weight or price |

| Setting | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| Warn about parked orders after | 12 hours by default |
| Blind count at close day | Count before seeing what's expected |
| Start the day before selling | Each till counts its float before its first sale (on for new shops) |
| Ask why when out by more than | GH₵ 5.00 by default |

## Receipts and orders

| Setting | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| Receipt printer | Network, USB (Windows) or Bluetooth (Android); 58 or 80 mm |
| Print every receipt | Automatic printing on this till |
| Cash drawer | Opens on cash; test button |
| Receipt design | Logo, header, footer, MoMo number, what shows |
| Order numbers, Order letter, Items that need prep | Kitchen orders |
| Kitchen printer | Where kitchen tickets print |
| Screens on other devices | Customer display, prep screen, Now serving |

## This device

| Setting | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| Lock the till after | Minutes of no use before locking (3 by default; never is possible) |
| PIN keypad | Standard, shuffled, or keyboard |
| Device name | How this till is named on the hub |
| Devices and hub | Make the hub, join a hub, add or remove devices |
| Scale | COM port or Bluetooth scale |
| Scan with the camera | The camera button (Android) |
| Notifications, Which notifications | Alerts outside the app |
| Theme | Light, dark, or follow the device |
| Products on the till, Till tile size | Grid or list; tile size |
| Larger text | Bigger letters everywhere |
| Language | English (more languages are coming) |

## Backup

| Setting | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| Automatic backups | On or off. Shows the last backup and when the next one runs |

| Setting | What it does |
|---|---|
| Back up every | 1 to 60 minutes, or once a day (30 minutes by default) |
| Back up now, Backups on this device | Make or restore a local backup |
| Backup folder | Where the backups are, with **Copy path** and **Open folder** |
| Send a backup off this device | Encrypted backup to share or save |
| Change the backup password | For new backups |
| Restore from a file | Bring back a backup |
| Backups to keep on this device | The newest 14, and one a day for 14 days, by default |
| Remind me to send a backup every | 7 days by default |
| Send this branch's data, Bring in a branch data file | Between branches (17.2) |
| Save the accountant's pack every month, Where the packs are saved | Monthly accounts (13.4) |
| Training mode | Practise (Part 19) |
| License | Activate Aby (1.4) |
| Version, Device ID, Data version | For support |

# 21. Questions and fixes

**The till won't let me sell. It says Aby isn't activated.** Activate Aby (1.4). On a till linked to a hub, activate the hub. Until then you can still look at reports, export and back up.

**The light went off in the middle of a sale.** Nothing is lost. When Aby opens again, the cart is still there. A sale is either fully saved or not saved at all, never half.

**The printer isn't printing.** Check it's on and has paper. The receipt is waiting: tap the status dot → **Try again**. Meanwhile you can **Send receipt** by WhatsApp or SMS. Test it in Settings → Receipts and orders → **Print a test page**.

**A customer's MoMo ID is refused.** That transaction ID was already used on another sale. Ask the customer for the message from *this* payment.

**I made a mistake on a sale.** Before close day: **Void** it (5.5). After close day, or if part was already refunded: **Refund** it (5.3).

**The drawer is short.** Look at the Z report: pay-outs, refunds and no-sales are listed per person. The activity log shows items taken off carts. Turn on **blind count** so counts are honest.

**Someone forgot their PIN.** Someone with *Manage staff* opens their page in Staff and sets a new PIN.

**The owner forgot their PIN.** Another owner, or anyone with *Manage staff*, can set a new one. If there is no one, tap **Forgot your PIN?** on the sign-in screen:

- **I have my recovery code:** type your staff number and the code, then choose a new PIN.
- **Ask my Aby supplier:** type your staff number and Aby shows a **request code**. Send it to your supplier with your shop's name. Once they've checked it's you, they send back a reset code. **You don't have to wait at the till.** Tap **Close for now** and staff can keep selling. The request stays open on that till for 7 days, and the sign-in screen shows **Enter your supplier's reset code** until you use it. Tap it, paste the code and choose a new PIN. The code works once, on that till. Typed the wrong staff number? Tap **Start again**. Remembered your PIN after all? Just sign in. Aby cancels the request, so a code arriving later won't work. Tell your supplier you don't need it.

Either way you're signed in and get a **new recovery code** to write down. The old one stops working. Lost your recovery code but still know your PIN? Make a new one from **My profile → PIN recovery**. The status dot warns owners who don't have one.

**I forgot the backup password.** Old `.abybak` files can't be opened without it. Set a new password (Settings → Backup → **Change the backup password**) and send a new backup off the till straight away. The backups kept on the till itself don't need the password.

**A till says "Cannot reach the hub".** Check the hub is on, Aby is open on it, and both are on the same Wi-Fi. The till keeps selling meanwhile, and everything syncs when it connects. If your router blocks the tills from finding each other, join by typing the hub's address and code.

**Products show twice after joining the hub.** Aby lists names that appear twice. Archive the extra ones.

**The status dot is amber.** It names what needs you, for example **Copy a backup off** (send a backup off the till, 18.3) or **No recovery code** (make one in your profile). Tap it, then tap the button beside the problem.

**The activity log says entries were changed outside Aby.** Someone edited Aby's data file directly. Talk to your Aby supplier, and restore a backup from before the change if needed.

**Can I use Aby on my phone?** Yes. Everything works on a phone: the menus move to the bottom, and the till shows a list.

**Does Aby need the internet?** No. Only things that leave the shop need it: sending a WhatsApp receipt, sending a backup to Drive, or getting your licence key.

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# 22. Quick reference

## Everyday keys (Windows)

| Key | Does |
|---|---|
| **Ctrl+K** | Search everything |
| **Enter** in search | Does the first result's first action |
| Type a number, then tap a product | Adds that many |
| Type a code, then **Enter** | Adds the product with that code |

## Who can do what (built-in roles)

| | Owner | Manager | Cashier | Stock keeper |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sell | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | |
| Refunds, voids, no-sale | ✓ | ✓ | PIN | |
| Close the day | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | |
| Products and prices | ✓ | ✓ | | products |
| Receive and adjust stock | ✓ | ✓ | | ✓ |
| Customers and credit | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| Write off credit | ✓ | | | |
| Cash, safe, expenses | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| Reports and profit | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| Staff, settings, devices | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| Roles | ✓ | | | |
| Restore a backup | ✓ | | | |

*PIN: someone allowed enters their staff number and PIN to approve.*

## Every day

| When | What to do |
|---|---|
| **Morning** | Sign in → **Clock in** → Today → Cash → **Start the day** (count the float) |
| **All day** | Sell, park, refund. Move cash to the safe when the drawer gets full |
| **Evening** | Everyone **clocks out** → check parked sales → **Check MoMo** → **Close day** (count the drawer) → send the daily summary. Owner: clear **Waiting for your decision** in Staff → Timesheets |
| **Every week** | **Send a backup off this device** |

| When | What to do |
| --- | --- |
| **Every month** | The accountant's pack (or let Aby save it by itself) |

# 23. Words Aby uses

| Word | Means |
|---|---|
| **Business day** | Your trading day. Starts at 05:00 by default (any hour up to 10:00), so late-night sales count on the evening's day |
| **Cart** | The items being rung up |
| **Close day / Z report** | The end-of-day count of the drawer |
| **Credit book** | Customers who buy now and pay later |
| **Delivery (DEL-0001)** | Stock that came in, with or without an order. Accountants call it a goods received note |
| **Float** | The cash in the drawer before the first sale |
| **Hub** | The till the others link to over Wi-Fi |
| **Margin** | Profit as a share of the price: cost 6.00 at 40% sells at 10.00 |
| **Markup** | Profit added to the cost: cost 6.00 at 40% sells at 8.40 |
| **MoMo** | Mobile money: MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash, AT Money |
| **No-sale** | Opening the drawer without a sale |
| **Parked sale** | A sale put aside to finish later |
| **Pesewa** | 1/100 of a cedi. GH₵ 1.00 = 100 pesewas |
| **Quick tab** | Your best sellers on the till |
| **Recipe** | What stock a product uses |
| **Start the day / X report** | The float counted at the start; the X report is the drawer since then |
| **Stock item** | Something you count: tubs, crates, bags, grams, litres |
| **Unconfirmed hours** | Hours of someone still clocked in when the day closed. Not paid until an owner decides |
| **Status dot** | The dot at the top: is everything safe? |
| **Training mode** | Practice that never touches real sales |
| **Void** | Cancelling a sale made by mistake |
| **Wallet** | Money you hold for a customer |

**aby** · Sell anyway.

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